

Be Curious

Here's a fact worth sitting with. ChatGPT launched in late 2022. Every expert you will ever compete with started learning these tools at almost the same moment you did. In most fields, adults have decades of experience on you. In AI, nobody has a ten-year head start, because the tools aren't ten years old.

That means the only seniority in AI is reps: hours spent actually using the tools, on real things, noticing what worked and what didn't. And reps are free. You don't need permission, a budget, or a job title. You need curiosity.

🔑 **Reps beat tricks.** Prompt tricks expire every time the models update. Instincts don't. Knowing what the tool will be good at before you ask comes from one place: using it, often, on real things.

FIVE CURIOSITY HABITS

None of these take extra time out of your week. They're small changes to things you already do.

1 Use it on real life, not just school

Planning a trip, fixing a bike, organizing a tournament, learning chords. Every new kind of task teaches you what the tool is actually good at. School assignments only show you a narrow slice.

2 Try the new thing the week it ships

New model, new feature: voice, vision, file uploads, whatever comes next. Most people wait until someone shows them. Be the one who already tried it.

3 Watch how other people use it

YouTube is full of people showing real AI workflows. Borrow what looks useful, then test it yourself before you trust it. You know how to check claims now. Use that.

4 Ask the tool to teach you the tool

The fastest way to find what you didn't know it could do is to ask.

“I want to get better at guitar. What are five different ways you could actually help me practice?”

5 Keep a list of what surprised you

Both directions. The time it nailed something hard, and the time it confidently botched something easy. The second list is the one that builds your when-not-to-trust-it instinct.

There's a line to watch, though. More AI isn't automatically more experience. It depends on which side of the work the AI is on.

Most of this course will age. Models will change, the traps will mutate, and the prompt advice will go stale. The habit of being curious about the new thing is the one part that doesn't expire. Keep it.